

OFFICIAL STATEMENT OF MITHRANDIR

REGARDING THE INVESTIGATION OF LORD ELROND HALF-ELVEN

Date: 27 Halimath, Fourth Age 19

Submitted to the White Council Intelligence Directorate

Having reviewed the testimony of Sauron, the collected witness statements, the facial comparison analysis, the genetic lineage report, and the scientific analysis of the Matrix hypothesis, I concluded that the matter could not be properly assessed through correspondence alone.

I therefore undertook a personal examination of the claims.

By means which are neither relevant to this report nor advisable for general use, I was able to briefly observe the realm described throughout the investigation as **"The Matrix."**

I can confirm that such a realm exists.

Whether this designation is its true name remains uncertain.

Nevertheless, the place described by Sauron is real.

The cities exist.

The towers exist.

The "Artificial Intelligence" exists.

The terminology contained within the testimony did not originate from the imagination of the witness.

In this respect, Sauron's account is substantially accurate.

During my observations, I encountered numerous individuals corresponding to descriptions previously recorded within this case file.

Several individuals wore dark garments of identical design.

Their eyes were concealed behind black coverings.

Many carried devices affixed to the ear.

Their manner was orderly, disciplined, and deeply unsettling.

These individuals correspond closely to the entities described by Sauron as "Agents."

More concerning were the machines.

I observed vast numbers of human beings suspended within metallic and glass structures, maintained by mechanisms beyond my understanding.

The purpose of these arrangements was not immediately apparent.

I elected not to remain long enough to determine it.

Certain questions are better left unanswered.

I must, however, address the central matter of this investigation.

During my time within the realm in question, I did not encounter Lord Elrond.

I did not observe any individual bearing Lord Elrond's appearance.

I did not observe any transformation involving Lord Elrond.

Nor did I discover evidence establishing a connection between Lord Elrond and the entities referred to as Agents.

On this point, the evidence presently available remains insufficient.

The allegations against Lord Elrond therefore remain unproven.

I have also reviewed the genetic findings concerning Lady Arwen Undómiel.

The conclusions appear sound.

Nothing observed during my investigation contradicts the established history of Lord Elrond, his lineage, or his relationship to his family.

My assessment is therefore as follows:

The realm described throughout this investigation exists.

The entities described as Agents exist.

The terminology recorded in Sauron's testimony exists.

The allegations concerning Lord Elrond remain unsupported.

There is one additional matter that should be noted.

During my observations, I learned that the realm in question is governed by an underlying system referred to by its inhabitants as "code."

According to those familiar with its workings, physical reality within that realm may be altered, manipulated, or rewritten through direct interaction with this system.

It is in this context that I came to understand several statements previously recorded within Sauron's testimony.

Most notably, the assertion that "there is no spoon."

This statement should not be interpreted literally.

The question is not whether a spoon exists.

The question is where it exists.

Within the reality of the Matrix, the spoon appears real and behaves as a spoon ought to behave.

Outside that reality, however, its existence becomes considerably more difficult to define.

The same may be said of food, buildings, cities, and perhaps even the individuals inhabiting them.

I cannot adequately express how deeply troubling this conclusion is.

The peoples of Middle-earth may disagree on many matters, yet we remain united in the understanding that a thing is what it is.

A spoon is a spoon.

A tree is a tree.

A meal is a meal.

Reality itself is not subject to negotiation.

The inhabitants of the Matrix appear to hold a different view.

I regard this as a danger greater than any weapon I observed during my investigation.

Should such ideas spread into Middle-earth, they would undermine the very foundations upon which our understanding of the world is built.

For this reason, I strongly advise against any further contact with the realm in question.

Let its philosophies remain its own.

Let its questions remain unanswered.

Let its code remain there and never reach our shores.

For if the peoples of Middle-earth ever begin to question whether a spoon exists, they will soon begin to question whether anything exists at all.

Recommendation

1. Lord Elrond should not be considered a threat on the basis of presently available evidence.
2. The investigation should remain highly classified and suspended indefinitely unless new evidence emerges.
3. Parts of Sauron's testimony should not be dismissed outright.
4. No further expeditions should be undertaken to the realm known as "The Matrix," nor should any effort be made to establish formal contact with its inhabitants.

Signed,

Mithrandir

Gandalf the White

Member of the White Council